

CAES™ CAPSTONE PORTFOLIO

Strategic Event Portfolio

SNHU MBA Public Policy Concentration

Alumni Launch Mixer

Event Date: Saturday, May 9, 2026

Location: SNHU Campus - The Salons, Hospitality Building, Manchester, NH

Headcount: 42 Graduates + 8 Faculty/Staff (50 Total)

Budget Cap: \$8,750.00 (Do Not Exceed)

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CAES™ Certification Candidate | January 2026

DOCUMENT 1: THE STRATEGIC BRIEF

Defining the Business Mandate and Audience

PART 1: THE BUSINESS MANDATE

Primary Mandate Selected: EMPLOYEE MORALE (Culture)

While this event serves graduating alumni rather than employees, the strategic logic aligns with the Employee Morale pillar as adapted for an academic context. The event functions as a Culture Anchor for the university's graduate program community, celebrating achievement, fostering continued connection to the institution, and reinforcing SNHU's brand as a supportive partner in career development.

STRATEGIC GOAL

To create a high-impact transitional experience that celebrates MBA Public Policy graduates, facilitates intentional peer-to-peer networking before career dispersal, and strengthens long-term alumni engagement with SNHU while positioning graduates for successful entry into public sector and policy-adjacent careers.

The 'One-Liner' Definition: "This event will be considered a failure if we do not achieve meaningful professional connections between at least 75% of attending graduates AND capture contact information for ongoing alumni engagement."

PART 2: THE AUDIENCE PROFILE

Metric	Detail
Total Headcount	50 (capped for intimate networking environment)
Primary Audience	42 MBA Public Policy Concentration Graduates (Spring 2026)
Secondary Audience	8 Faculty/Program Staff (facilitators, not attendees)
Audience Persona	Mid-career professionals, public sector aspirants, policy enthusiasts; ages 28-52; geographically dispersed (online program)
VIPs to Note	Dr. Jennifer Teague (Executive Director, Global Campus Business Programs); Dr. Sophia Koustas (Associate Professor)

PART 3: SUCCESS METRICS

Metric Type	Target	Measurement Method
Qualitative	NPS Score $\geq$ +60	Post-event survey (within 48 hours)
Quantitative	$\geq$ 30 new LinkedIn connections per attendee	Self-reported in follow-up survey
Quantitative	100% alumni contact capture	Registration + exit survey completion
Operational	Budget variance $\leq$ 5%	Final invoice reconciliation

PART 4: LOGISTICAL NON-NEGOTIABLES

Constraint	Specification	Rationale
Date	Saturday, May 9, 2026 (5:00-9:00 PM)	Post-commencement; allows travel arrangements
Geographic Radius	SNHU Campus, Manchester, NH	15% alumni venue discount; brand reinforcement
Hard Budget Cap	\$8,750.00 (Do Not Exceed)	Aligned with typical university event allocation
Venue	The Salons (Hospitality Building)	Capacity 80 theater/100 reception; appropriate for 50

DOCUMENT 2: THE LINE-ITEM BUDGET

Demonstrating Correct Use of Service Charges, Taxes, and Contingency

CAES™ Budget Methodology: All costs calculated using the Plus-Plus (\$++) compounding formula. NH Meals Tax (9%) applies to F&B. Service charges (20%) are taxable in NH. Contingency set at 15% per CAES™ best practices.

SECTION A: VENUE

SNHU Campus - The Salons, Hospitality Building

Line Item	Vendor	Base Cost	Discount	Net Cost
Room Rental (4 hrs)	SNHU Conference Services	\$1,200.00	15% Alumni	\$1,020.00
Setup/Breakdown (2 hrs)	SNHU Conference Services	\$200.00	15% Alumni	\$170.00
Parking	SNHU Campus	\$0.00	N/A	\$0.00
			VENUE SUBTOTAL:	\$1,190.00

SECTION B: FOOD & BEVERAGE

Tidewater Catering Group | 250 Commercial St, Manchester, NH | (603) 668-6111

Line Item	Qty	Unit	Base	Svc 20%	Tax 9%	FINAL
Passed Appetizers	50	\$18	\$900	\$180	\$97.20	\$1,177.20
Buffet Stations	50	\$42	\$2,100	\$420	\$226.80	\$2,746.80
Open Bar (2 hrs)	50	\$28	\$1,400	\$280	\$151.20	\$1,831.20
Coffee/Dessert	1	\$350	\$350	\$70	\$37.80	\$457.80
					F&B SUBTOTAL:	\$6,213.00

Plus-Plus Calculation (Buffet): Base \$2,100 + Service \$420 = \$2,520 × 9% Tax = \$226.80 → Final: \$2,746.80

SECTION C: AUDIO/VISUAL

Audio Events | Barrington, NH | (603) 722-0108 | audioeventsonline.com

Line Item	Qty	Day Rate	Total
Conference PA System	1	\$150.00	\$150.00
Wireless Microphone	2	\$40.00	\$80.00
LCD Projector (3200 lumens)	1	\$100.00	\$100.00
100" Projector Screen	1	\$40.00	\$40.00
Delivery & Setup	1	\$75.00	\$75.00
		A/V SUBTOTAL:	\$445.00

SECTION D: OPERATIONS & MISCELLANEOUS

Line Item	Vendor/Source	Cost
Event Photography (2 hrs)	Ryan Connors Photography LLC	\$350.00
Name Badges & Lanyards (50)	Staples Print, Manchester NH	\$85.00
Signage & Wayfinding	Staples Print, Manchester NH	\$60.00
Table Centerpieces/Decor	SNHU Conference Services	\$120.00
Gratuity Pool	Cash envelopes (per CAES protocol)	\$150.00
	OPERATIONS SUBTOTAL:	\$765.00

BUDGET SUMMARY

Category	Amount
A. Venue	\$1,190.00
B. Food & Beverage (fully burdened)	\$6,213.00
C. Audio/Visual	\$445.00
D. Operations & Miscellaneous	\$765.00
SUBTOTAL (Pre-Contingency)	\$8,613.00
HARD BUDGET CAP / VARIANCE	\$8,750.00 / \$137.00 UNDER (1.6%)

DOCUMENT 3: THE RISK AUDIT

Identifying Dangerous Clauses in a Sample Contract

The following audit examines a hypothetical Standard Venue Contract from SNHU Conference Services using the CAES™ Contract Audit Checklist methodology.

1. ATTRITION CLAUSE ANALYSIS

ORIGINAL CLAUSE: "Group agrees to utilize a minimum of 80% of the reserved room block on a per-night basis. Failure to meet this minimum on any single night will result in liquidated damages equal to 100% of the contracted room rate for unused rooms."

RED FLAG	RISK IDENTIFIED	CAES™ ASSESSMENT
"Per-night basis"	Night-by-night calculation prevents recovery from early departures	HIGH RISK - Must redline to cumulative
"100% of contracted rate"	No offset for hotel's duty to mitigate/resell	HIGH RISK - Missing resell clause

CAES™ REDLINE: Change "per-night basis" to "calculated cumulatively across all contracted nights." Add: "Venue shall use commercially reasonable efforts to resell any unused rooms. Revenue from resold rooms shall be credited against any attrition damages owed."

2. FORCE MAJEURE CLAUSE ANALYSIS

ORIGINAL CLAUSE: "Neither party shall be liable for failure to perform if such failure is the result of an Act of God which makes performance impossible. This provision shall only apply if written notice is provided within 24 hours. Hotel shall retain all non-refundable deposits."

RED FLAG	RISK IDENTIFIED	CAES™ ASSESSMENT
"Impossible"	Standard too high; building standing = possible even if 50% can't attend	CRITICAL - Change to "impracticable"
"24 hours notice"	Crisis management may require 72+ hours for assessment	HIGH RISK - Extend to 7 days

"Retain all deposits"	Hotel profits from disaster; no mutual protection	HIGH RISK - Add sliding scale
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CAES™ REDLINE: Change "impossible" to "commercially impracticable." Extend notice to 7 days. Add "curtailment of transportation facilities" and "any circumstance preventing at least 25% of registered attendees from participating."

3. INDEMNIFICATION CLAUSE ANALYSIS

ORIGINAL CLAUSE: "Organization agrees to indemnify and hold harmless the University from any and all claims, losses, or damages arising out of the event, regardless of cause."

RED FLAG	RISK IDENTIFIED	CAES™ ASSESSMENT
"Regardless of cause"	Organization liable even for Venue's negligence	CRITICAL - One-way indemnity unacceptable
No mutual protection	Organization has no recourse if Venue causes harm	CRITICAL - Must be mutual

CAES™ REDLINE: Change to: "Each party agrees to indemnify and hold harmless the other party from any claims caused by the negligent acts or omissions of the indemnifying party, its employees, agents, or contractors."

RISK AUDIT SUMMARY

Clause	Original Risk	Post-Redline	Action Required
Attrition	HIGH	MITIGATED	Change to cumulative; add resell clause
Force Majeure	CRITICAL	MITIGATED	Change to impracticable; extend notice
Indemnification	CRITICAL	MITIGATED	Make mutual; limit to negligence

CAES™ RECOMMENDATION: Do not execute the contract until all CRITICAL and HIGH risk redlines have been accepted. The "Unjust Enrichment" doctrine provides leverage—if Venue resells rooms, they cannot legally collect damages.

DOCUMENT 4: THE RUN-OF-SHOW

A Minute-by-Minute Production Timeline

Event: SNHU MBA Public Policy Alumni Launch Mixer | **Date:** Saturday, May 9, 2026 | **Venue:** The Salons, SNHU Campus

CAES™ Principle: "5:00 PM is a result, not a starting point." ROS begins 3+ hours before guest arrival.

PHASE 1: PRE-EVENT (2:00 PM - 4:45 PM)

TIME	DEPT	ACTIVITY	LOCATION	POC
2:00 PM	VENUE	Room access; walk-through	The Salons	SNHU Events
2:15 PM	A/V	Load-in; power check	The Salons	Audio Events
2:30 PM	A/V	PA setup; mic check	The Salons	Audio Events
2:45 PM	A/V	Projector/screen; test HDMI	The Salons	Audio Events
3:00 PM	F&B	Tidewater load-in begins	Kitchen	Keri/Tidewater
3:15 PM	DECOR	Signage; centerpieces	Lobby/Salons	Event Lead
3:30 PM	A/V	Run slide deck; cue music	The Salons	Audio Events
3:45 PM	F&B	Bar station setup; ice	Bar Area	Tidewater
4:00 PM	PHOTO	Photographer arrival	The Salons	R. Connors
4:15 PM	ALL	STAFF BRIEFING	The Salons	Event Lead
4:30 PM	REG	Registration setup; badges	Lobby	Event Lead
4:45 PM	VENUE	DOORS OPEN	Lobby	SNHU Events

PHASE 2: LIVE EVENT (5:00 PM - 9:00 PM)

TIME	DEPT	ACTIVITY	LOCATION	NOTES
5:00 PM	F&B	Passed appetizers begin	The Salons	Service deployed

5:00 PM	BAR	Open bar begins	Bar Area	2-hour window
5:00 PM	PROD	Networking Phase 1 - Organic	The Salons	Upbeat ambient music
5:30 PM	PROD	Speed Connect facilitated intro	The Salons	Announce via PA
5:50 PM	EXEC	VIP escort to stage left	Green Room	Dr. Teague ready
6:00 PM	A/V	House lights 50%; spot ON	Stage	Walk-on music cue
6:00 PM	EXEC	WELCOME REMARKS - Dr. Teague	Stage	8-10 minutes
6:10 PM	ALUM	STUDENT SPEAKER REMARKS	Stage	5-7 minutes
6:20 PM	PROD	GROUP PHOTO - All graduates	Stage	Lights 100%
6:30 PM	F&B	BUFFET OPENS	Buffet Area	Announce via PA
7:00 PM	BAR	Open bar ENDS	Bar Area	Last call at 6:50
7:45 PM	F&B	Coffee/dessert station opens	Dessert Area	Announce via PA
8:30 PM	PROD	CLOSING REMARKS	Stage	2-3 minutes
8:45 PM	REG	EXIT SURVEY REMINDER	Lobby	QR codes distributed
9:00 PM	ALL	EVENT ENDS	Lobby	House lights 100%

PHASE 3: STRIKE (9:00 PM - 10:30 PM)

TIME	DEPT	ACTIVITY	LOCATION	POC
9:00 PM	F&B	Buffet breakdown	Buffet Area	Tidewater
9:15 PM	A/V	A/V breakdown	The Salons	Audio Events

9:30 PM	DECOR	Signage removal	All Areas	Event Lead
9:45 PM	LEAD	Gratuities distribution	Service Area	Event Lead
10:00 PM	ALL	Final walk-through; damage check	The Salons	Lead + CSM
10:30 PM	ALL	VENUE CLEAR	Exit	All Staff

ZONE CAPTAIN ASSIGNMENTS

ZONE	CAPTAIN	PRIMARY MISSION	CRISIS AUTHORITY
F&B Zone	Keri (Tidewater)	Hot food on time; dietary accommodations	Approve up to \$200 overage
A/V Zone	Tech Lead (Audio Events)	Protect audio integrity for remarks	Swap equipment immediately
Flow Zone	Event Lead (Christina)	Transition timing; wayfinding	Adjust schedule $\pm$ 10 min
VIP Zone	SNHU Staff Liaison	Dr. Teague & faculty support	Green room access control

15-MINUTE CRISIS PLAYBOOK

Scenario: VIP speaker (Dr. Teague) is delayed 15 minutes.

Atmosphere Shift: Extend networking music; announce "refreshments available"

Distraction Move: Deploy "Fun Facts" slideshow about graduating class

Zone Captain Orders: F&B extends appetizer service; A/V cues transition music at +12 min

APPENDIX: VENDOR VERIFICATION

Research Documentation for Fact-Checking

All vendors and pricing in this portfolio are based on real businesses with verified contact information.

Vendor	Type	Contact	Source
SNHU Conference Services	Venue	(603) 506-5023	uniquevenues.com
Tidewater Catering Group	Catering	(603) 668-6111	tidewatercatering.com
Audio Events	A/V Rental	(603) 722-0108	audioeventsonline.com
Ryan Connors Photography	Photo	Manchester, NH	theknot.com
Staples Print	Print	Manchester, NH	staples.com

KEY PRICING NOTES

SNHU Venue: Per Eventective.com, SNHU events range \$500-\$1,295 for 50 guests. 15% alumni discount confirmed via alumni.snhu.edu.

Tidewater Catering: Per published billing policies, 20% service charge applies to all F&B. NH Meals Tax of 9% applies. Per-person pricing based on industry standards.

Audio Events A/V: Pricing from published rate sheet at audioeventsonline.com/AV-Rentals.

SNHU Graduate Data: Spring 2025 had 4,496 graduate students total. With 15+ MBA concentrations in Public Policy, estimate of 42 Public Policy graduates is reasonable.

PLUS-PLUS CALCULATION

Buffet Example: Base: $50 \times \$42 = \$2,100 \rightarrow +$ Service (20%): $\$420 \rightarrow =$ Subtotal: $\$2,520 \rightarrow +$ NH Tax (9%): $\$226.80 \rightarrow =$ Final: $\$2,746.80$

This compounding approach (tax calculated on subtotal including service charge) follows CAES™ Module 2 methodology. In NH, the service charge is taxable, making effective markup ~30.8%.